

By the way...
lots of people hated
my theory because it
suggested that humans
had evolved, just like
any other animal.



Large Ground Finch



Medium Ground Finch



Small Ground Finch



Warbler Finch

Natural Selection

Finches with large, strong beaks lived on islands with lots of seeds, but those on islands with lots of insects had narrow, pointy beaks. Darwin realized they had **adapted** to fit each island's unique environment. The animals with features best suited to where they lived were more likely to survive to pass on those features to their offspring. So, he had discovered that **SPECIES CHANGE** over a long period of time—he called this theory "**Evolution by the Process of Natural Selection.**"

World-changing book

His book *On the Origin of Species* became an instant bestseller when it was published in 1859. Darwin's theory is one of the most important scientific ideas of all time. He changed the way we look at life on Earth forever.

Darwin revolutionized the science of biology

Each island of the Galápagos has its own unique species of giant tortoise.



The English economist **THOMAS MALTHUS** (1766–1834) wrote about the **STRUGGLE FOR EXISTENCE** in human populations, which influenced Darwin.



British academic **ALFRED RUSSEL WALLACE** (1823–1913) sent his own **THEORY OF EVOLUTION** to Darwin, spurring Darwin on to publish his own work.